7-2 Project Three

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While currently functional, the event-tracking app I designed for this project requires several more components before it can be fully launched and considerations should be made regarding the app's potential future development.

App Branding

Currently, one of the ways the app stands out is with its vibrant blue and orange color scheme. Thus, any further visual branding of the app should also feature these colors, including the app's icon. The icon should make it clear that the app is used for tracking events and could do so by evoking calendar imagery. Specifically, the icon could consist of a rounded square with intersecting lines forming a grid, reminiscent of how dates are displayed on a calendar. This calendar grid should have an aqua background with dark blue borders around the squares, matching the colors used for events in the app. To further differentiate the app's icon and communicate its SMS notification feature, the icon could also depict an exclamation point symbol overlayed on top of the calendar grid. This exclamation point should be orange to incorporate the other primary color of the app.

As for the app's description, it too should make the app's purpose clear. The app should be marketed as a simple event-tracker that lets users add and delete events easily. The description should also inform potential users of its ability to send SMS messages on the day of an event. However, it should simultaneously be made clear that this feature is optional and the app will still function if the user opts not to use the SMS notification functionality.

Versions

Rather than setting the minimum SDK to the most modern version, I chose an older version to significantly increase the potential userbase for the app. The minimum SDK I

designed the app to run on is API 24, also known as “Nougat” or Android 7.0. This means that it should be able to run on 99.2% of devices, including the most current version.

Permissions

My app asks for three permissions “SEND_SMS,” “READ_PHONE_NUMBERS,” and “READ_PHONE_STATE.” The “SEND_SMS” permission is required to allow the app to send SMS notifications on the day of an event. Related to this, the “READ_PHONE_NUMBERS” and “READ_PHONE_STATE” permissions are needed to get the phone number of the current device so that SMS notifications can be sent. Notably, these permissions solely pertain to the SMS notification feature of the app. This means that if a user declines to give the app access to any or all permissions, the app will still function and will simply not send SMS notifications.

Monetization

While not impossible, monetizing this app poses some problems due its simplicity. The most obvious monetization option would be to add advertisements, but this would need to be done carefully. Given that the app only really has three screens, if ads are displayed on any of these screens it will be very noticeable. This may frustrate users and result in them uninstalling or ceasing to use the app. Because of this, I would recommend that only the least used screen be considered for advertisements, with this being the screen seen when editing or adding events. If this is done, the app could be downloaded for free but also offer an option for users to pay money for a full version that removes ads.

Alternatively, the app could require a one-time purchase to download. However, this may be the worst option for monetization as it is hard to imagine users paying for such a simple app when there are similar apps available for free.

The last option I would consider would be to make the app free and not have ads but offer a paid full version with extra features like color customization or more options for SMS notifications. This would likely be the most respectable monetization plan and the one that is the least compromising to the app's usability. However, this obviously means that more development time would need to be spent on the app to add the new features offered in the full version.

Given the options I laid out, I would likely choose to make the app free without ads and offer a paid version. However, if I were unable to work on the app further to add new features, I would simply put advertisements on the screen where events are added and edited. If my development time were severely limited, I may even forgo the option for a paid version that removes ads.